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Akifumi ISHIHARA

Contact Information

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Personal

Name (Given - Family): Akifumi Ishihara
Citizenship: Japan.

Positions

Institute of Social Science, University of Tokyo, Japan.

Professor (Kyoju), April 2023 –.

Associate Professor (Junkyoju), April 2019 – March 2023.

National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies, Japan.

Associate Professor (Junkyoju), April 2018 – March 2019.

Assistant Professor (Jokyoju), April 2015 – March 2018.

Graduate School of Economics, Kyoto University, Japan.

Senior Lecturer (Koshi), August 2012 – March 2015.

School of Business and Economics, RWTH Aachen, Germany.

Post Doctoral Fellow (Wissenschaftliche Mitarbeiter), October 2011 – July 2012.

Education

Ph.D in Economics, London School of Economics and Political Science, U.K., 2012.

M.A. in Economics, University of Tokyo, Japan, 2006.

B.A. in Economics Hitotsubashi University, Japan, 2004.

Research and Teaching Interests

Contract Theory, Industrial Organization and Marketing, Organizational Economics, Political Economics and Public Choice.

Publications

Articles in Refereed Journals

1. "Profit-Enhancing Emissions Taxes in Near-Zero-Emissions Industries" (with Kosuke Hirose and Toshihiro Matsumura), *Energy Economics*, (2026) 160: 109461.
2. "Tax versus Regulations: Polluter's Incentives for Loosening Industry Emission Targets" (with Kosuke Hirose and Toshihiro Matsumura), *Energy Economics*, (2024) 136: 107705.
3. "Exclusive Content in Two-Sided Markets" (with Ryoko Oki), *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy*, (2021) 30(3): 638–654.
4. "Pre-emptive Production in Oligopoly with Private Information" (with Yuki Amemiya and Tomoya Nakamura), *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy*, (2021) 30(2): 449–455.
5. "On Multitasking and Job Design in Relational Contracts," *Journal of Industrial Economics*, (2020) 68(4): 693–736.
6. "Strategic Candidacy for Political Compromise in Party Politics," *Journal of Theoretical Politics*, (2020) 32(3): 389–408.
7. "Dark Sides of Patent Pools with Compulsory Independent Licensing" (with Noriyuki Yanagawa), *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, (2018) 57(1): 1–34.
8. "Transparency and Performance Evaluation in Sequential Agency" (with Susumu Cato), *Journal of Law, Economics, & Organization*, (2017) 33(3): 475–506.
9. "Relational Contracting and Endogenous Formation of Teamwork," *RAND Journal of Economics*, (2017) 48(2): 335–357.
10. "Relational Political Contribution under Common Agency," *Journal of Public Economic Theory*, (2017) 19(2): 527–547.
11. "Minor Candidates as Kingmakers" (with Shintaro Miura), *Public Choice*, (2017) 170(3), 253–263.
12. "Role of Information Rents in Relational Contracts," *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy*, (2016) 25(4), 936–957.
13. "Concessions and Repression in Conflict" (with Prakarsh Singh), *B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis & Policy*, (2016) 16(2), 865–899.

Working Papers

1. “Managing Strategic Communication for Monetary Transfers.”
2. “Delegation and Strategic Silence” (with Shintaro Miura).
3. “Wholesale Contracts and Exclusivity for Mixed-homing Consumers” (with Ryoko Oki).
4. “Cooperation or Collusion? Rents in Relational Contracts for Teams” (with Akitoshi Muramoto).
5. “Managing Authority and Incentives in Relational Contracts.”

Publications Written in Japanese

See <https://akishihara.github.io/Japanese/index.html>.

Teaching Experience

Undergraduate

Calculus, Game Theory, Industrial Organization, Mathematical Economics, Microeconomics, Organizational Economics.

Graduate

Contract Theory, Game Theory, Industrial Organization, Microeconomics, Organizational Economics.

Advising

Ph.D Dissertation Committee

U of Tokyo: Jiahao Li (2025), Qianmao (Ted) Zhu (2023), Takaaki Hamada (2023), Susumu Sato (2020).

GRIPS: Doan Ngoc Thang (2018).

Kyoto U: Kazunobu Okubo (2015).

Recent Presentations

2026: SSCW 2026 (Tokyo), OEIO (Online), Chonnam National University.

2025: CTW Summer Camp 2025 (Hakodate), Tokyo University of Science.

2024: CTW Summer Camp 2024 (Sendai), Workshop on Search and Platform (Tokyo).

2023: CTW Summer Camp 2023 (Kanazawa), Organizational Economics Workshop (Tokyo), 2023 JAAE Spring Meeting (Fukuoka), Osaka U, National Taiwan U.

2022: Keio U, 2022 JEA Autumn Meeting (Tokyo/Online), AMES 2022 (Tokyo/Online), OEIO (Online), Hiroshima U, Kyoto U.

2021: OEW '21 (online), CPW (online), CU Boulder (online), SWEO (Otaru), 27th DC Conference in Japan (online), Hitotsubashi U (online), EARIE 2021 (online), 7th Workshop on Relational Contracts (online), ESAM 2021 (online).

2020: U of Tokyo (online), SWET (Otaru), CTWZ (online, *2), Keio U (online), IOCP Workshop (Oita).

2019: Yokohama National U, APIOC 2019 (Tokyo), 2019 JEA Autumn Meeting (Kobe, Poster), Japanese-German Workshop on Contracts and Incentives (Munich), EARIE 2019 (Barcelona), CTW Summer Camp 2019 (Hirosaki), OEIO (Osaka), 2019 International Conference on Labor, Industrial Economics, and Growth (Taipei), U of Tokyo.

2018: APIOC 2018 (Melbourne), Michael Waldman Workshop on Internal Labor Markets (Tokyo), Tokyo University of Science, OEIO (Osaka), EARIE 2018 (Athens), CTW Summer Camp 2018 (Kushiro), SIOE 2018 (Montréal), Osaka U, 2018 JEA Spring Meeting (Hyogo), Hitotsubashi U, CTW (Osaka), Game Theory Workshop (Osaka), OEIO Tokyo Conference (Tokyo), IOCP Workshop (Oita), Waseda U (*2). (January)

2017: APIOC 2017 (Auckland), The 7th MAEDA (Tokyo), EARIE 2017 (Maastricht), SWET (Otaru), CTW Summer camp 2017 (Nagasaki), SIOE 2017 (New York), AMES 2017 (Hong Kong), Keio U, OEIO (Osaka), Hitotsubashi U.

Discussants

2025: JEA Autumn Meeting (Hirosaki).

2024: Economic Theory Workshop in Memory of Dr Makoto SHIMOJI (Tokyo), JEA Spring Meeting (Tokyo).

2022: JEA Spring Meeting (online).

2021: JEA Autumn Meeting (Osaka).

2020: JEA Autumn Meeting (online).

2019: East Asian Contract Theory Workshop (Yokohama), JEA Spring Meeting (Tokyo).

2018: East Asian Contract Theory Workshop (Seoul), JEA Autumn Meeting (Tokyo).

2017: The 11th Japan-Taiwan-Hong Kong Contract Theory Conference (Hong Kong), JEA Autumn Meeting (Tokyo).

2016: Workshop on Competition and Public Policy in Network Industries (Nishinomiya), The 10th Japan-Taiwan-Hong Kong Contract Theory Conference (Tainan), 14th annual International Industrial Organization Conference (Philadelphia).

2014: JEA Spring Meeting (Kyoto).

2013: The 7th Japan-Taiwan Contract Theory Conference (Hualien), JEA Autumn Meeting (Yokohama).

Professional Activities

Refereeing Services

Applied Economics Letters, Bulletin of Economic Research, B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis & Policy, Economic Modelling, Economics & Politics, Games and Economic Behavior, Hitotsubashi Journal of Economics, International Journal of Economic Theory, International Journal of Industrial Organization, Japanese Economic Review, Journal of Economic Theory, Journal of Economics & Management Strategy, Journal of Institutional and Theoretical Economics, Journal of Law, Economics, & Organization, Journal of Mathematical Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of the European Economic Association, Kyoto Economic Review, LABOUR, Management Science, Manchester School, RAND Journal of Economics, Review of Network Economics, Social Choice and Welfare, CPRC Discussion Paper Series, ISER Moriguchi Prize, Israel Science Foundation.

Organizers and Committees

Programme Committee, The 28th Decentralization Conference in Japan at the University of Tokyo, October 2022.

Programme Committee, Japanese Economic Association Spring Meeting online (hosted by Kwansei Gakuin University), May 2021.

Organizer, Summer Workshop on Economic Theory, 'Industrial Organization and Contract Theory,' August 2019.

Co-Organizer, Sapporo Workshop on Industrial Economics, February 2018, February 2019, March 2022, March 2023.

Programme Committee, Tokyo Conference on Economics of Institutions and Organizations, March 2019, August 2019.

Programme Committee, Japanese Economic Association Autumn Meeting at Sophia University, October 2015.

Local Committee, The Seventh Annual Meeting of the Association of Behavioral Economics and Finance at Kyoto University, December 2013.

Scholarships and Grants

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (B, Co-investigator, Project Number: 25K00640), 2025-.

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (C, Project Number: 24K04830), 2024-.

The Telecommunications Advancement Foundation Research Grant (Co-investigator, PI: Ryoko Oki), 2023-.

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (C, Co-investigator, Project Number: 21K01405), 2021-2025.

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (B, Co-investigator, Project Number: 20H01503), 2020-2025.

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (C, Project Number: 20K01603), 2020-2024.

KDDI Foundation Research Grant Program (Co-investigator, PI: Ryoko Oki), 2020-2023.

Japan Center for Economic Research Grant, 2020-2023.

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (A, Co-investigator, Project Number: 18H03640), 2018-.

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Young Scientists (B, Project Number: 17K13724), 2017-2021.

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (C, Co-investigator, Project Number: 16K03667), 2016-2019.

JSPS (KAKENHI) Grant-in-Aid for Young Scientists (B, Project Number: 26780144), 2014-2017.

Kyoto University Start-up Grant-in-Aid for Young Scientists, 2012-2014.

AMES Travel Grant, 2011.

LSE Michio Morishima Fund, 2011.

LSE Research Studentship, 2009, 2010.

Mext Scholarship for Long-term Study Abroad, 2006-2009.

JASSO First Class Scholarship (with full repayment exemption), 2004-2006.

Language

English (Fluent), Japanese (Native).

References

Available upon Request.